

Opal Health Care Case Study

Assessment Item 4 - INFO6050



Figure 1.

(Reviews Opal HealthCare Employee Ratings and Reviews | SEEK, n.d.)

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Executive Summary

Leading Australian provider of residential care for the elderly is Opal Health Care. Due to a number of internal and external factors, including a lack of government funding for residential aged care, adults' preference to spend their later years with loved ones, a lack of qualified care staff, and others, Opal was encouraged to transition from the current system, which is a provided care, to a self-managed aged care system. The goal is to make the most of the organization's efforts in the self-managed care strategy.

Over 400 fatalities and 27,000 hospital admissions are caused by falls each year in NSW. The number of people who fall over the age 65 are increasing. According to studies, residents of facilities for the elderly experience falls more frequently. As a result, Opal Health Care is emphasizing the prevention of falls, which can be handled through self-managed care. However, the reporting system for the fall management protocol, which falls under health management, has been the study's main focus.

The Opal healthcare fall management protocol's current system has been found to be incredibly ineffective. This is because the current systems for reporting incidents and asking for help when someone falls are both on a human level. Our research showed that even more than one in three seniors over 65 experience at least one fall per year requiring assistance from an aged care facility. To lessen the chance of falling, this should be minimized. As a result, our suggested procedure that included telemonitoring of ECG that is integrated in a small wearable sensor will prevent elders from falling because it provides information about impending falls. However, it was found that fall detection with a wearable accelerometer sensor was more practical and effective. Our research demonstrates that Opal can transition into effective self-managed care while investing the primary strength quality care and qualified staff on the subject.

Organizations should act quickly to take the necessary steps in order to achieve this. First, an organizational survey and stakeholder interviews need to be done. The position of the power/interest matrix should be taken into consideration when designing the interview format. Hold workshops and conduct studies on the application of wearable technology and digital systems for fall detection and prevention. A high percentage of falls are caused by poor health and wellbeing. It is emphasized that HRV is a suggestive measure that can be used to lower the percentage of falls among seniors. Therefore, it is the duty of aged care to require patients to engage in regular exercise, have a healthy diet, and get enough sleep in order to have a favorable short-term HRV rate.

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Introduction

In Australia, Opal Health Care is a leading provider of senior care. With a warm and welcoming atmosphere for all residents, it offers high-quality aged care services. The service begins with high-quality clinical care, social and recreational opportunities, and ties to the community to improve residents' physical, social, and mental well-being.

The government and the majority of Opal Health Care competitors have undergone reform into self-managed care, where seniors can live independently at home with the assistance of aged care providers. Opal Health Care is concentrating on helping residents transition to self-managed care (SMC). Their main goal is to extend the amount of time each resident spends managing their own care.

Before implementing the aforementioned strategic change, a number of factors need to be taken into account. Since stakeholders have the most impact on the aforementioned concept, they must conduct a careful analysis. Prior to developing recommendations for the aforementioned concept change, external factors like political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental must be taken into account.

The goal is to keep an eye on potential situations that could lead to a change from self-managed to provided-managed care. and make the most of the period of self-managed care. The reporting system and health management are topics that the care residents are interested in. In order to provide recommendations for the new reform, these two areas must therefore be further examined.

The study's Business Overview Modelling section presents the current and suggested business process models. Rich images, activity diagrams, and use case diagrams are used to present processes.

Under the heading of "Stakeholder analysis," a study of stakeholders is presented. It includes stakeholder identification, a power/interest matrix, and stakeholder management tactics.

Strategic analysis is followed by PESTLE analysis, which examines how external factors impact an organization when undergoing reform. In order to determine the organization's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats, a SWOT analysis is presented.

The final section, Current Process Identification and Next Steps presents scenarios for current processes and suggestions for them to transition to self-managed care.

Report Goals

The main objective of this study is to examine potential outcomes of the Opal health care system's current procedure, which prioritizes managed care delivery over self-managed care, and to make recommendations for its facilitation.

The purpose of this study is to explore the stakeholders in order to better understand their reasons for supporting Opal Health Care and what they hope to gain from the project in order to gain their support. However, macroeconomic factors need to be researched before a new change in the company is implemented. The foundation for the analysis of the organization's current situation will be a stakeholder and strategic analysis. In light of the aforementioned evaluations, my objective is to describe the current Opal healthcare process and offer recommendations to help with the transition from the currently offered managed care to self-managed care.

The study focuses on the leadership team, care team, partners, and residents or those who stand to gain from the provided healthcare.

Business Overview Modelling

Rich picture of the current situation of Fall management protocol

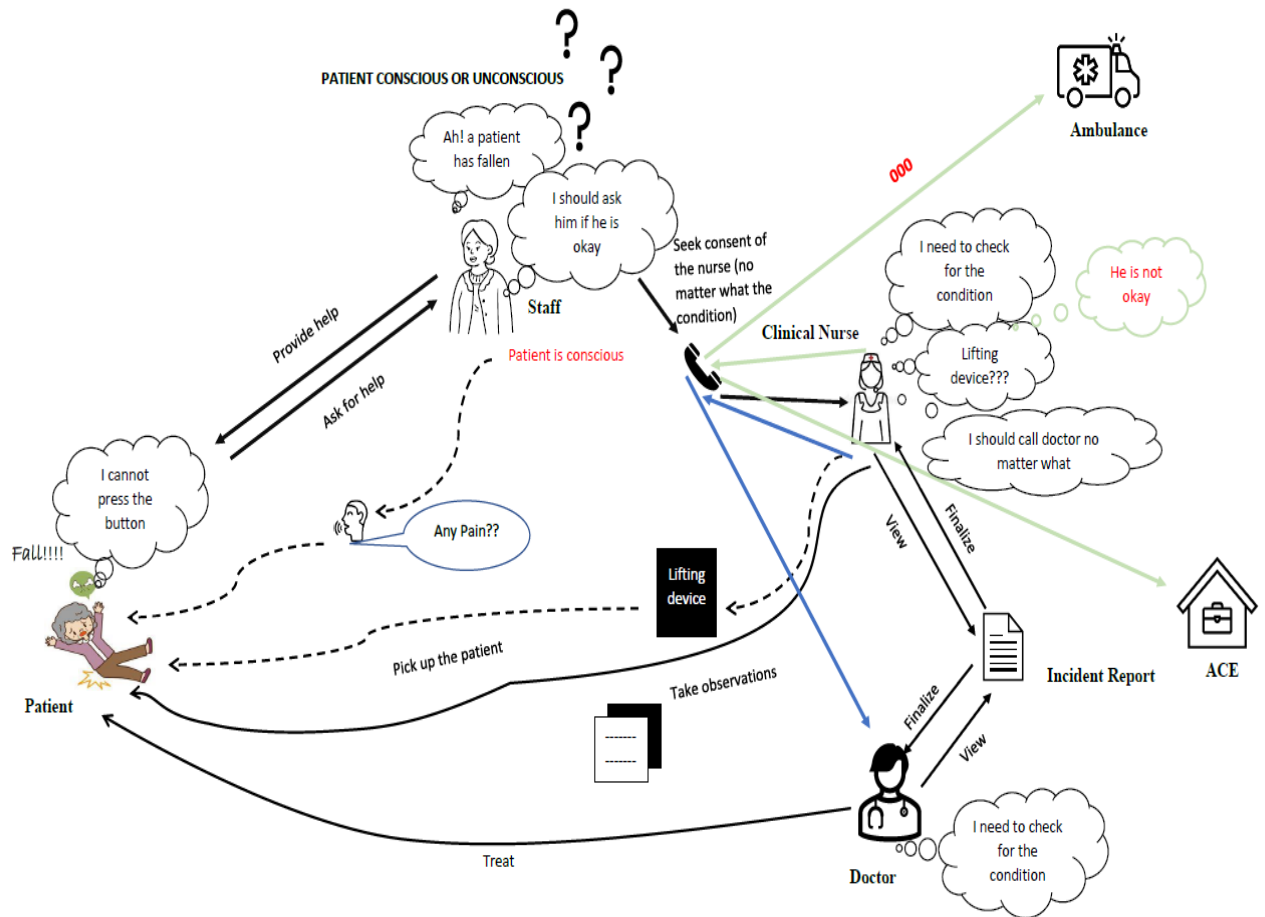


Figure 2.

Activity diagram

AS-IS

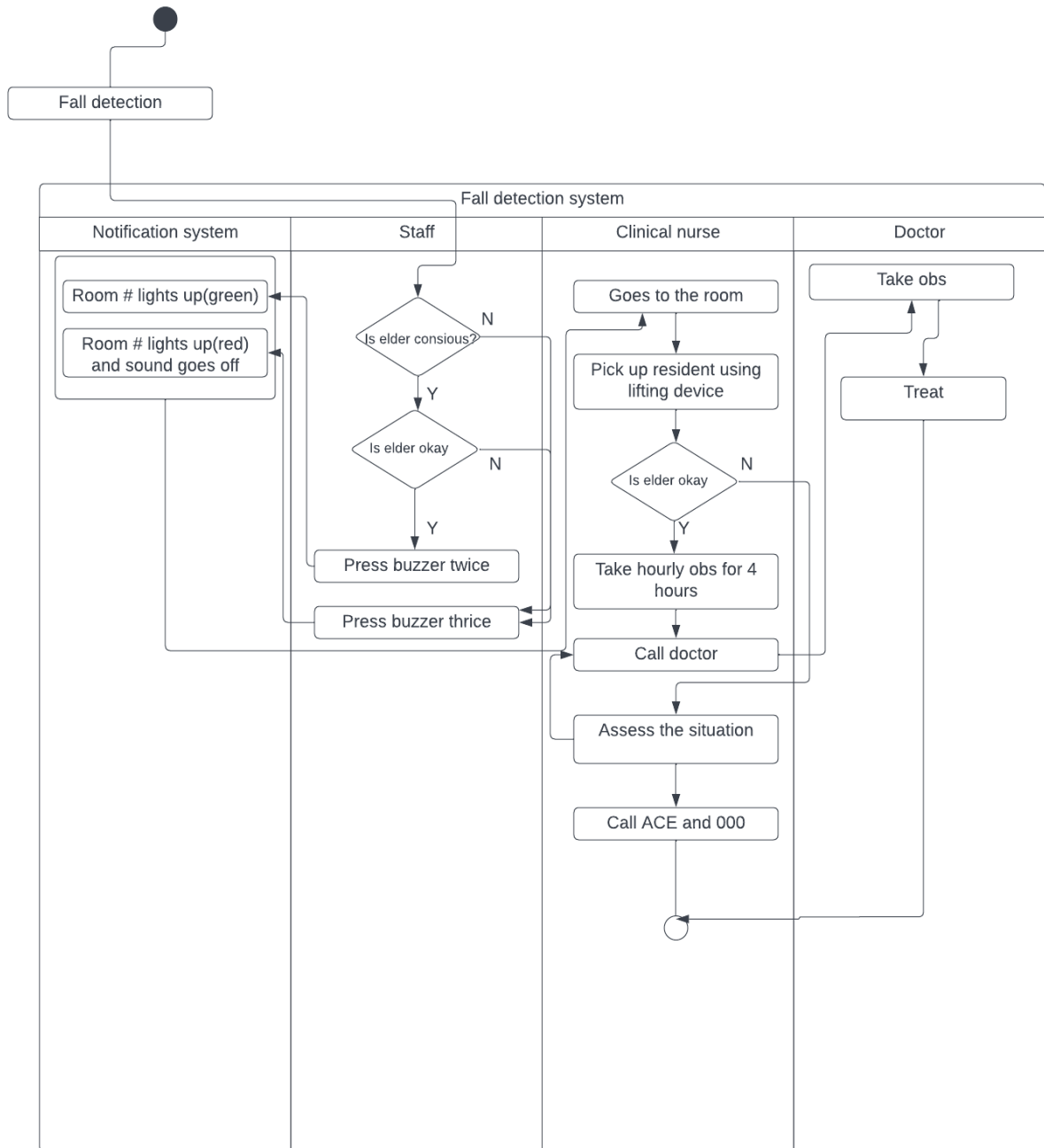


Figure 3.

TO-BE

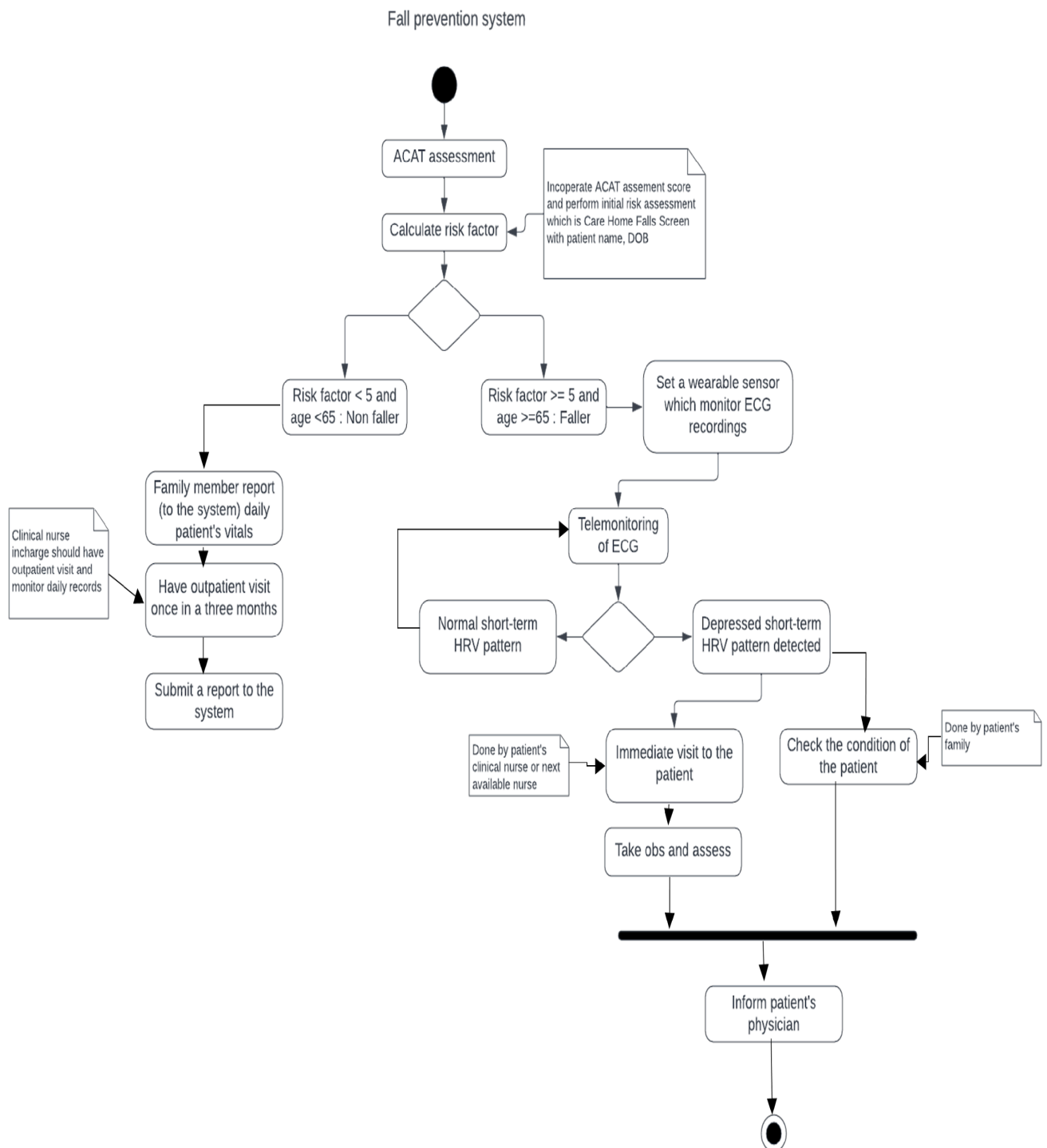


Figure 4.

Use case diagram

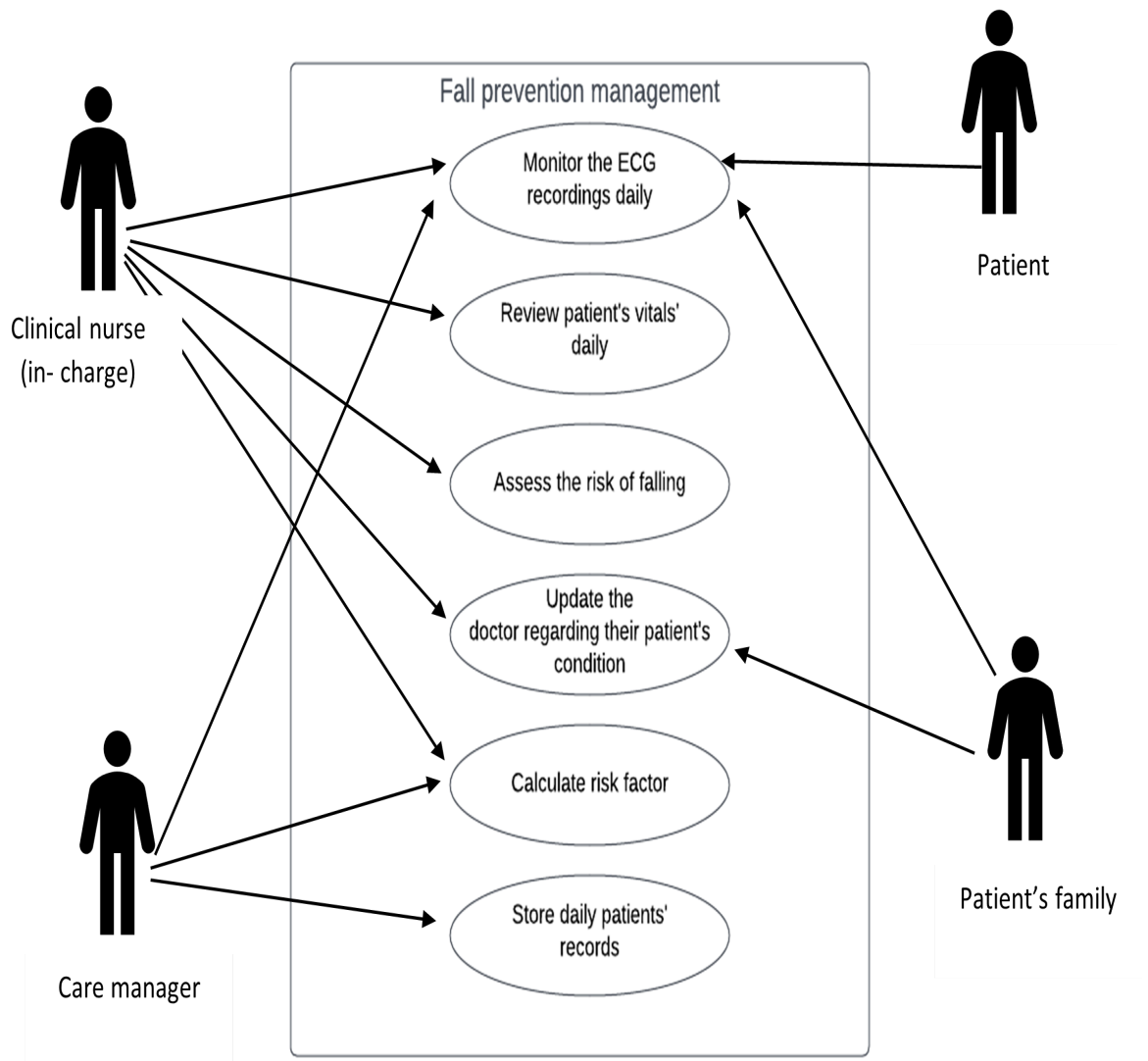


Figure 5.

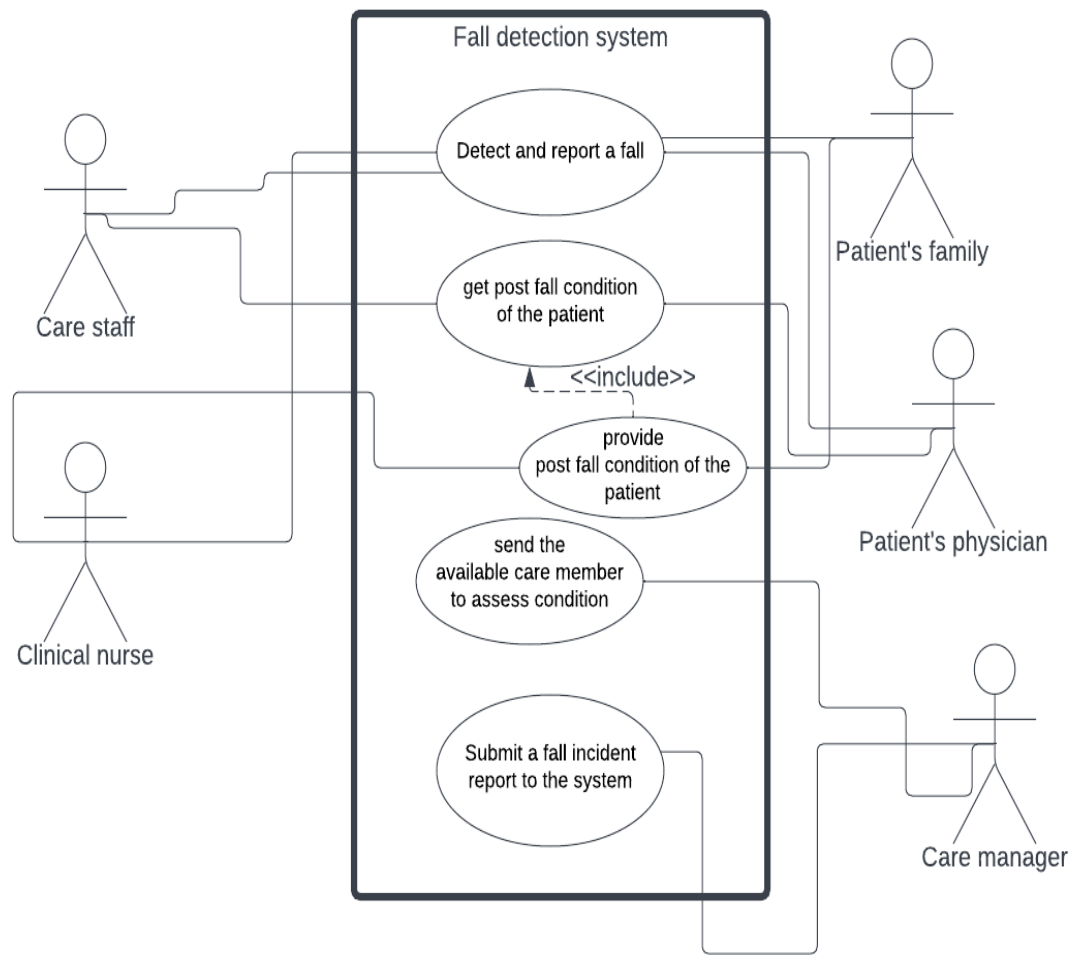


Figure 6.

Stakeholder analysis

A business analysis project's success is greatly influenced by stakeholder analysis and management. Stakeholder analysis entails the steps of stakeholder identification, stakeholder analysis, and stakeholder management strategy development. Identifying and comprehending stakeholders' expectations from the project is necessary to identify risks, issues, or misunderstandings that could result in the project failing. Then, you can take action to address issues in order to win support and improve results.

The analysis's goal is to pinpoint the stakeholders, their driving forces, and what they anticipate from Opal Health Care in order to win them over and secure their backing for the project's development.

Identifying stakeholders

Chair

Organize and direct the board's activities. Evaluate their performance and ensure that the organisation is managed properly and effectively.

Chief Executive Officer

Help the aged care to become more focused and find possibilities for expansion and invent new strategies and business plans. Also built its capital and advance the fulfillment of its goals. (*Leadership Team. (n.d.). Opal HealthCare*)

Chief Operating Officer

Focuses on creating culture, career development opportunities and structure that will support our 8,500 people to continually deliver exceptional and compassionate care for the residents. (*Leadership Team. (n.d.). Opal HealthCare*)

Director, Communication and Sustainability

Working to establish and shape the Opal Health Care culture promotes open communication with clients and stakeholders, makes it simple for people to comprehend the services and what makes them unique, and increases the benefits of care communities in society.

Chief Financial Officer

Help organisation achieve its financial goals.

General counsel and company secretary

To improve disease diagnosis and treatment, the person in charge of all industry engagement and technology commercialization activities collaborates closely with medical professionals and researchers.

Director, Customer experience, Business improvement and assurance

Assistance with customer insights and analytics, customer relationship management, digital transformation, strategic project management, and process improvement for the organization. His team recreates the residential aged care experience using their people, processes, and technology.

Director of people and culture

devoted to enhancing the lives of each team member through ongoing training and professional development, a welcoming culture based on common values, and leadership excellence and capacity across Opal. (*Leadership Team. (n.d.). Opal HealthCare*)

Chief Information Officer

According to him, leveraging technological breakthroughs is crucial to providing superior aged care services. Focused on delivering a trusted and reliable technology service across Opal and helping to shape the technology transformation and innovation.

Director Clinical Services

“Lead the clinical services and quality program, focusing on continuing to build and embed excellence in clinical care.” (*Clair Ramsden | Director of Clinical Services | Opal HealthCare*)

Director of Business Development

responsible for steering Opal's expansion plans through partnerships, business expansion, and acquisitions. Look for creative ways to help the team members offer that care, as well as to help Opal HealthCare continue to develop on its already solid roots.

Director of Property

Committed to creating built environments where residents can maintain a sense of community and autonomy in a homely environment that also supplies the best clinical care.

Partners

Affect the customer experience, customer development, and vocational and educational training in ways that help our team members, residents, and communities succeed. Help to enhance the emotional and physical health and well-being of the residents. Have partnership with tertiary education providers, allied health providers, and specialist organisations.

Regional General Manager

Accountable for managing quality, risk management, HR, and financial performances. Oversees 12 homes in Sydney, Dubbo, Orange, Mudgee and Bathurst. Manage daily operations and services. Lead care team. Assist in budget planning, focusing on rentals and financial income.

Registered Nurses

Provide clinical support to the residents, so that to ensure they receive the best quality of life possible.

Care Managers

Lead the care staff which includes nurses. Ensure resident lifestyle and care needs are met. Daily clinical management.

Chef

Prepare fresh and nutritious meals daily.

Aged care residents

Key stakeholders which are benefited by aged care.

Power/Interest matrix

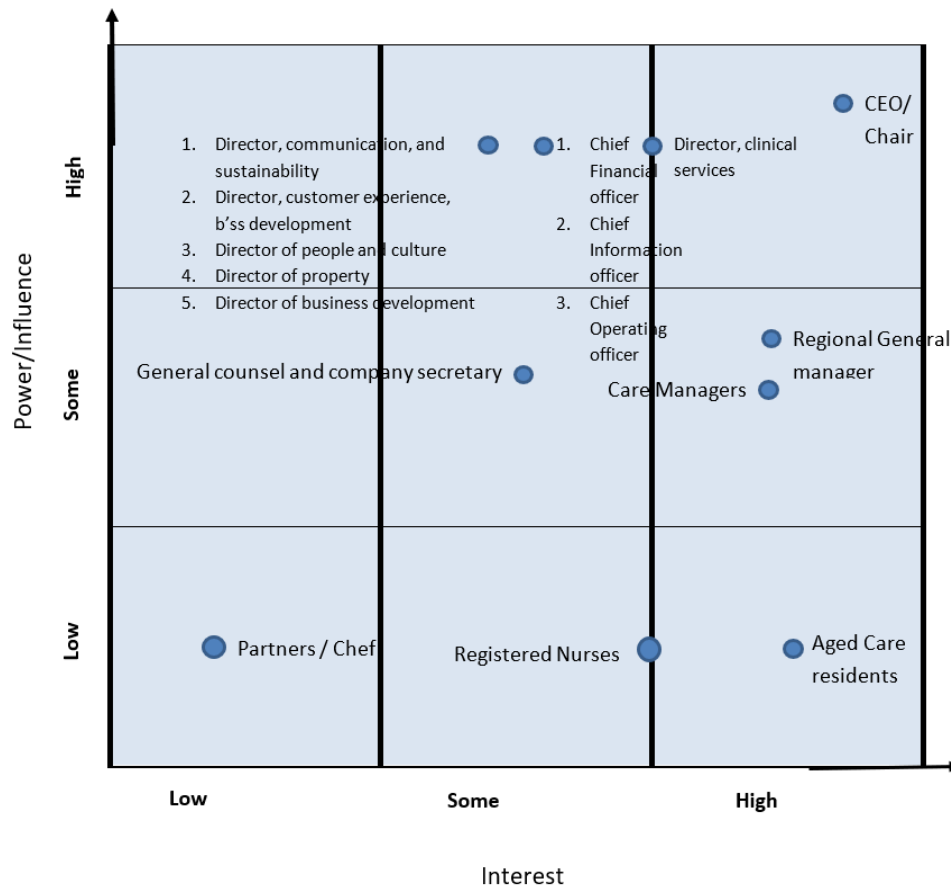


Figure 7.

Managing Stakeholders

Situation	
No or low interest and no or low power/influence	Partners and Chef comes under this situation. These types of stakeholders should be observed constantly. But they have neither interest nor power on Opal health care project. You do not need to bother them with excessive communication. Again, you must monitor them as they will change their position with time.
Some or high interest but no or low power/influence	Registered Nurses, Aged care residents occupy with this category. Both stakeholders are powerless, thus difficult to manage. These stakeholders are highly affected by a change in project. Residents at nursing homes will be most impacted by a change because they tend to have higher levels of interest. And since they are powerless, they cannot do anything to shape the direction of the change. This may cause annoyance and passive resistance to change, which, even when overcome by positional authority, may cause delays and less-than-ideal outcomes. Similar scenario can occur with registered nurses with a lesser degree. Thus, these stakeholders must be kept informed throughout the project. And we should supply reasons for every proposed change within the project.
No or low to high interest but some power/influence	General counsel and company secretary, care manager, regional general manager comes under this varied group. All these stakeholders are middle level or senior level managers. General counsel and company secretary oversee industry engagements and technology commercialism. Thus, he gets involved in a situation of the above-mentioned area. Therefore, they are not concerned about the direction of the project and have some power. Again, care managers and regional general managers have more interest in the project but again some power.

	To manage them we must have frequent communication with them and have their support for the progress of the project.
Some interest but high power/influence	All directors and chief officers except the chief executive officer come under this category. These stakeholders have varied degrees of interest, but again have high power. The reason for some power is all of them have different areas to look at but have little interest in the direction of the project. To manage them we need to satisfy them and not let them feel ignored. Also, they should increase their interest, as there may be situations where their impact is extremely concerned. So, we must keep these types of very influential stakeholders satisfied.
High interest and high power/influence	The key players of the project. The chair and CEO are the key players of the project. They are both interested and powerful on the project. It is critical to figure out whether these stakeholders have a positive or negative attitude towards a project. If so, it is important to maintain their enthusiasm, especially in difficult conditions. You must respect the issues and opinions of significant stakeholders and take them into account when making any recommendations.

Table 1.

Strategic analysis

PESTLE Analysis

Apart from internal factors and resources, organisation can be significantly impacted by several additional macro-economic factors. In a situation where a new change is introduced into the organization, these factors must be considered.

PESTLE analysis is one of the approaches used to analyze these macro-economic factors relevant to a particular situation.

The following PESTLE analysis was carried out on Opal health care.

Political

An organization that offers high-quality elderly care is Opal Health Care. In Australia, Government funded aged care providers must follow the policies issued for the aged care service. Under the Aged Care Act of 1997, all aged care providers must follow the quality standards. One of the biggest political effects on the Opal health care organization is this. Leading Age Services Australia (LASA) contends that they have a responsibility to provide residents with high-quality care, respect elders' rights, and keep them safe. Meanwhile, like other aged care providers, Opal Health Care also must meet the expectations of the staff and supply benefits.

Australian aged care policies have decided to reform in-home aged care. In the future this new policy will have an impact.

In addition, aged care governance requires a significant improvement so that the government can provide funding for Opal health care to deliver high-quality services.

Economical

The lack of professionals in the field of elderly healthcare is a major problem for Opal Health Care. This might be the result of inadequate government funding. Despite the fact that the government has established a basic daily care fee and a mean-tested care fee for the care residents, these amounts are insufficient to provide high quality care and satisfy employment expectations.

Socio – cultural

Australia's changing demographics significantly influence the demand for and provision of Opal health care. Analytics show that the elderly population has grown more significantly in recent years. Thus, this growth rate has increased the demand for aged care.

Apart from that, lifestyle at retirement age is much more challenging. Thus, supplying a resident much suitable for the lifestyle of aged people, lot to think about.

Technological

Innovations in technology have a significant impact on Opal healthcare. The Royal Commission's implementation of a digital care system gives seniors automated, real-time, high-quality aged care. This system is quickly improving and would provide greater benefits for Opal health care.

Lack of data management process on aged population by Australian government influence for the aged care in supplying quality service.

Legal

Aged Care Quality and Safety Commission, established by the Australian government, aims to safeguard and improve the safety, health, well-being, and quality of life of those receiving aged care. The commission independently accredits, assesses, and monitors the aged care. They have set rules to ensure the health, well-being, safety, and quality of life of aged care consumers.

(*"Aged Care Quality and Safety Commission | Dementia Australia"*)

The Aged Care Act 1997 is the primary legislation that details Australian Government-funded aged care. The act supplies rules and regulations for:

- funding
- regulation
- approval of providers
- subsidies and fees
- standards
- quality of care
- rights of people receiving care
- non-compliance.
- diversity and discrimination

(*Understanding Policies and Procedures in Aged Care, 2021*)

Thus, above factors directly influence on Opal health care.

Environmental

Covid 19 pandemic caused a major impact on Opal health care. The new COVID 19 regulations and procedures should be maintained to guarantee the wellbeing and safety of elderly patients receiving care.

Residents and staff have adopted the "go green" philosophy, which emphasizes resource conservation through reuse, recycling, and repurposing.

SWOT analysis

Before introducing a new strategy, a SWOT analysis was conducted to evaluate the organization's current situation.

		Strengths	Weaknesses
Internal		- Opal health care has able to provide high quality, person-centered residential care for age population. - Aged residents can participate in a variety of activities that encourage social interaction and provide them a sense of happiness, purpose, and meaning in their lives. - Opal health care has professional, <u>educated</u> and qualified care staff. - Opal health provide several career opportunities and education through the partnership with pioneer tertiary education institutes in Australia.	- Lack of professional workers for care staff. - Opal health care provide service for in care residents only, while most of the aged care providers have introduce in home or self-managed care system.
		Opportunities	Threats
External		- Government needs to issue new quality standards for independent living system of aged care. - With the professional staff of Opal health, it is possible to reform to this independent living system incorporating cutting edge technologies.	- Not possible to provide high quality and managed care to the residents with the lack of staff. - With low funding provided by government, it is not possible to maintain quality aged care standards as expected.

Figure 8.

Current process Identification

Management at Opal Health Care has put a protocol in place to lessen the risk of falls, which happen frequently to elderly people.

The current systems for reporting issues and requesting assistance are evaluated here in accordance with the fall management protocol. However, it is possible to identify three processes in these systems that could undergo changes. Processes are as follows:

- Fall detection notification process
- Report taking process
- Care staff are mindful of risk

Process 1: Fall detection notification process

It is discovered that the current system of asking for help and fall detection mechanisms is incredibly ineffective. Since the fall detection is done at the human level, it might cause a patient's fall to be responded to slowly. As a result, the detection and aiding processes need to be automated and converted to digital systems. The fall detection system's effectiveness will increase as a result.

Automated digital systems can be added to this process to increase efficiency, decrease risk of falls, improve response times, and take immediate action when necessary.

A wearable sensing device with an accelerometer that is integrated into a real-time fall detection system is necessary to accomplish this. To alert medical personnel and the patient's family, this wearable device also needs to be Bluetooth-connected to an Android device.

There may be restrictions as a result of the care staff's and patients' relatives' limited knowledge of digital systems. The placement of the wearable device is another problem.

Process 2: Report taking process

The way reports are currently taken appears to be on a human level. By modifying digital reporting systems, this procedure can be enhanced to maximize self-managed care time. With the current system, taking the incident report requires physically going there, but a digital system can improve this. The modification aims to increase the reporting system's automation while minimizing human error.

The process' goals are to guarantee that the incident report is free of inaccurate background information and that the clinical nurse and attending physician can quickly assess and decide on the patient's condition after falling.

Real-time report taking via a digital, automated system is a requirement for the process, and clinical nurses, physicians, and care staff must be acknowledged for using the system.

Process 3: Care staff are aware of potential risks.

When put through the current process, the care staff's level of risk awareness is at mid-level. As a result, it is necessary to raise the level of risk awareness among staff members. This is due to the fact that risk awareness should be kept at a higher level when maximizing self-managed care time because the patient is with family and you should manage the situation skillfully.

Next Steps

Process 1:

The company can offer workshops and certificate-level courses to provide a foundational understanding of handling digital systems in order to bring about change in this process. By forming partnerships with outside organizations, these courses and workshops can be offered. Organizations can, in the interim, carry out surveys and research on the functionality of the digital system that supports wearable devices. Selecting the best digital system to detect falls may be made easier using this method.

Process 2:

Have previous research on the mistakes that have occurred and might occur with a reporting system based on humans. Hold a survey on switching to an automated digital system of reporting fall incidents in light of the company's financial circumstances and by interviewing responsible stakeholders.

Process 3:

To educate care staff about the risk of an elderly person falling, workshops can be held. The entire care team, excluding clinical nurses, must be covered by this. Risk can be decreased by implementing HRV, which is a best practice. Monitoring HRV on a daily basis is another way to stay alert to risks. Despite these restrictions, organizations can encourage patients to engage in daily exercise with a doctor's approval. Both the patient's eating habits and sleeping habits can be known to the staff.

Falls can happen as a result of postural hypertension, weakness, and dizziness. Staff members ought to be aware of these circumstances.

Conclusion

The most significant area on which the organization concentrated was fall prevention. Over 30% of elderly people who fall put their lives in danger. Due to falls, the majority of elderly people may become paralyzed or completely disabled, while a small number of them also pass away. The prevalence of these falls in residential care homes has been noted as a major concern for providers of residential care. This presents a significant challenge for Opal Healthcare. The main point to be focused on when choosing to emphasize self-managed care is turning fall management protocol into a digital system.

Therefore, it is advised to adapt a wearable accelerometer to detect falls and incorporate telemonitoring ECG integrated wearable digital system to monitor HRV records, both of which are very practical in the prevention of falls. When transitioning to a self-managed care system, this can be very helpful.

The study's ultimate goal is to maximize the self-managed care system under the protocol for managing falls.

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